

A decorative background on the left side of the slide featuring a pattern of colorful, abstract shapes resembling stained glass windows in shades of blue, yellow, red, and green.

Planning for the next few years of All Saints' online

4/20/26



BEFORE WE LOOK

Why we're updating

There is no perfect website. Only a next good one.



GOING UP

Future-proofing

Still works in 3–5 years, not just today.

Security

Fewer ways things can break or get attacked.

Findability

The right people finding us when they search.

Accessibility

Works for all ages, devices, and abilities.



GOING DOWN

Time to make an update

A typo, a service time, a photo, a new sign-up.

Technical knowledge required

Anyone on staff or vestry can learn it quickly.

Ongoing maintenance burden

Fewer plugins to break, fewer things to chase down.

For most newcomers,
the website is the first visit.

On a phone.

The website is how the welcome gets tested — before the “welcome” ever happens.



Quick, mobile, and judgment-heavy.

~80%

Check the website first

Of people who eventually visit a church in person had visited its website beforehand. The website is usually the first meeting.

~78%

On a phone

Of traffic to church sites arrives on a mobile device. Small screens are the norm, not the exception.

10 sec

To decide it feels right

Researchers estimate visitors form a first impression of a site within the first ten seconds on the homepage.

~75%

Trust is shaped here

About three in four say a church's website influences whether the place feels healthy and trustworthy — before meeting anyone.

3 things

What they want first

Service times. What to expect. Are my kids safe. Almost every visitor is looking for some version of these before anything else.

All

Ages use the site

Older newcomers use church websites too. The site has to work well for them, not just the tech-fluent.

Five things. That's most of the homepage job.

01

Service times

When. Where. Traditional vs family services.

02

What to expect

Times, how to dress, where to go, Communion practice. The first fifteen minutes.

03

Are my kids safe?

Nursery. Sunday school. Who's supervising. Photos help a lot.

04

Who are you?

Plain language about beliefs. What being Episcopal means.

05

How do I show up?

Address. Parking. A name and email to reach with a question.

Most of what a newcomer does on a church site maps to one of these five. Everything else is supporting content.

What other Episcopal parishes put online.

Jubilee Episcopal

Austin, TX · founded 2022

PLAIN SPOKEN WELCOME

Young, growing parish. Homepage leads with "a holy welcome," Sunday at 9:30, families welcome, a pray-ground for little ones. Straightforward language, no Episcopal jargon left unexplained.

jubileeatx.org

Church of the Incarnation

Dallas, TX · since 1886

OLD PARISH, MODERN SITE

Roughly 5,000 members, Sunday attendance near 1,000 — the closest Episcopal parallel to a megachurch. Proof that a 140-year-old parish can have a modern, welcoming site.

incarnation.org

Trinity Episcopal Cathedral

Portland, OR

HOSPITALITY, FIRST

"Red doors swing wide to embrace people of many faiths and no faith at all." Service times and welcome come before history or organizational structure. Warm, human tone.

trinity-episcopal.org

Different scales, different flavors. Each welcome's newcomers in the first few seconds.

What vibrant parishes share.

We looked at 18 Episcopal parish websites — fastest-growing, largest and most visible, and affirming parishes in conservative regions. Here's what shows up on most of them.

16/18	“Giving” CTA in the header or hero The most consistent call-to-action	16/18	Facebook, Instagram, and a giving link in the footer Facebook + Instagram + YouTube is the standard triad (14/18).
14/18	A discoverable “Plan a Visit” / “I’m New” / “Visitors” page Named differently across sites	13/18	Service times visible higher up on the homepage The first question a newcomer asks, answered without scrolling.
12/18	Livestream surfaced in hero or top nav Watching online is now an expected entry point	11/18	Real parish photography in the first homepage images Actual people, actual building — not stock.

What a welcome page can actually do.

Eleven things a first-time visitor might look for. How often we saw them on the visitor pages we reviewed.

Service address	17/18	Communion practice	7/18
Episcopal mention	16/18	Parking instructions	5/18
Service day(s)	14/18	What to wear	5/18
Service time(s)	14/18	Service length	4/18
Affirming / welcoming statement	13/18	Where to enter	3/18
Kids / nursery info	10/18		

What the rare-but-specific sites do well

- Christ Church Kennesaw names stepless entrances and the Parish Hall ramp, and tells visitors to cross their arms at the altar for a blessing.
- Grace Yukon directs visitors to the Gathering Space left of the front doors; greeters help from there.
- Jubilee Austin is blunt: “no dress code. Seriously.” A service lasts about an hour. All are welcome to receive communion.

Design best practices

Fewer menu items

5–6 top-menu items.

Fewer decisions for a visitor to make means the right one is easier to find.

Real photos, not stock

Actual people, actual building, actual services.

Stock photography reads as generic — real photos read as trustworthy.

Generous whitespace

Breathing room around text makes pages feel calmer, easier, more welcoming. Crowded pages feel busy and anxious.

Works on a phone first

Text stays readable, buttons stay tappable, the service time is still easy to find on a small screen.

One clear next step per page

Avoid multiple competing calls to action. "Plan your visit." "Watch a service." One gentle invitation at a time.

Clear wording about services

If there's a casual service and a traditional service, they're named plainly.

Three ways All Saints' could show up online.



OPTION 1

The *Original*

Our first redesign pass. Clean, functional, familiar. A straightforward refresh of what's already there.

- Familiar
- Functional
- Clean



OPTION 2

The *Sanctuary*

Timeless and refined. Large serif type, generous whitespace, editorial feel. Leans into the reverence of a 148-year parish.

- Editorial
- Reverent
- Spacious



OPTION 3

The *Gathering*

Vibrant and alive. Bold photography, warm energy — a church moving, people connecting, kids learning.

- Bold
- Photo-driven
- Warm

PART TWO

Beyond the website.

Social media, and how the pieces of our online presence fit together.

80% planned. 20% of the moment.

A rotating evergreen backbone built around the church calendar, with room left for what's happening this week.

80%

Evergreen rotation

Built once, runs all year

MON	Episcopal fact or tradition	Bi-weekly
TUE	Church or parish history	Bi-weekly
WED	Feature from Episcopal media	Every 3 weeks
THU	Ministry spotlight	Monthly
SUN	Service reminder / lectionary	Weekly

20%

Of the moment

What's happening this week

- Weather closures & schedule changes
- Events, fundraisers, service projects
- Photos from recent services
- Rector or vestry announcements
- Seasonal / liturgical moments

HOW IT WOULD ACTUALLY RUN

One person. A quarter at a time.

Scheduled content is the best approach for small teams — it trades 'always on' for 'plan once, post steadily.'

PLATFORMS

Instagram + Facebook

Where people searching for a progressive, liturgical parish in Cabarrus County are most likely to look. One post, both channels.

SCHEDULING TOOL

Buffer (or similar)

Free tier covers our volume. Sit down once per quarter, schedule 80% of the content, and step away. The weekly 20% can be posted anytime.

TIME REQUIRED

A few hours per quarter

One staff member or volunteer can run this. No special skills beyond writing a caption and picking a photo, and a perfect task for AI. No ongoing daily work.

A seeker's path to a Sunday morning.

1

Searches online

Googles 'episcopal church concord nc' on a Tuesday night.

2

Finds our Instagram

Sees recent posts, with one about Holy Week.

3

Clicks through to the website

Lands on a 'Newcomers' page. Service times, what to expect, who we are.

4

Reads about the clergy

Photos, short bios, a message from the rector.

5

Watches a livestream

Sunday morning, from her couch. Gets a feel for the liturgy and the room.

6

Walks in the door

The following week. She already knows the building, the people, the pace.

Going live: no long season under construction.

When we move on a direction, here's what to expect

WHERE THINGS STAND

Three designs, ~75% built

The design work that usually takes months has already happened. What's left is choosing a direction, finalizing content, and a round of review.

THE SWITCHOVER ITSELF

One evening. Zero downtime.

When we're ready, the new site replaces the old site in a single window overnight. Visitors the next morning see the new site. Nothing is ever 'under construction' publicly.

IF WE WANT TO PAUSE

Reversible at any stage

Until we flip the switch, the current site keeps running exactly as it does today.

A MOMENT TO PIVOT, LOOK AROUND, UPDATE

There is no perfect website.
Only a next good one.

PROPOSED NEXT STEPS

- Decide which things to include
- Vote on design direction
- Vote on final design
- Decide on a date to launch